SpeechGeek

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One of our goals in publishing **SpeechGeek** is to introduce the forensic world to new and talented writers. Traditional publishers often neglect promising writers. Other publishers are often clueless as to the needs of forensics performers. The material found in **SpeechGeek** is written by veteran and new forensic students and coaches. We strive to provide a product that is fresh and challenges the conventions of what makes a great performance. The most rewarding part of this process is that the material is left in your hands to make the final decision. You get to explore the emotions, characters, and stories. We may provide the material, but the end result is completely up to you. **Season Three starts here and what a season it will be!**

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pipe Dreams

by Andy Birge

NARR. In a time long past, there once lived a man and his brother with the ability to make right where there was once wrong, peace where there was chaos, and nothing where there was once spaghetti. These that I speak of are the brothers Mario...

LUIGI. Wait! Why does it have to be all about Mario? Mario....Mario...Mario...

NARR. But isn't your last name Mario?

LUIGI. Well...yeah, but I mean...WHAT KIND OF NAME IS MARIO MARIO ANYWAY? (*turns away sobbing*)

(Toadstool wanders into the room.)

TOAD. Hhhheeey guys...you got any candy? (*staggers*)

LUIGI. What's up Toadstool? Look at me. Let me see your eyes. Are you drunk again?

TOAD. Yeah. So?

LUIGI. SO, it's 9:30 in the morning.

TOAD. Hey, let me tell you something, I love you man...No, I mean it...I really love you man...(*mumbles off*)

LUIGI. Have you paid the utilities yet?

NARR. Like I was saying before, the Mario Brothers have revolutionized our world as well as the Mushroom Kingdom. I am here today with Luigi Mario, faithful sidekick and brother to the world famous Mario Mario. So, Luigi, I see that you have gained a few pounds since we last saw you. What happened?

LUIGI. Well, mainly, I was tired of maintaining my image. After our life story was made into a movie, my reputation was ruined. I attribute the fall of my career to John Leguizamo. Hollywood wanted to make me seem like the pansy sidekick. Back in the day, I ran the game.

NARR. So, what have you and the crew been up to over the past fifteen years?

LUIGI. Well, Mario and I don't speak much since the plumbing business went down the drain. No pun intended. Since he went on the Atkin's diet, he thinks he's too good for me, rolling in royalties and spaghetti sauce. He doesn't eat the noodles anymore, though—or the mushrooms.

NARR. No mushrooms?

LUIGI. Well, the mushrooms from the Kingdom are *really* high in carbs. Haven't you seen that fool? He's emaciated, but he still has the best parties, I'll give him that. Everyone's there...me and Toad, the Princess, all the goombas, Bowser...

NARR. Bowser?

LUIGI. Oh, Bowser gave up his life of crime long ago when he married. It's shunned upon and everything--marrying outside of the game. It's an issue to some, but I don't care.

(Cut to interview with Bowser, AKA King Koopa.)

BOWSER. There is only one way. We must find the light that lies within us in order to find our ultimate purpose. Isn't that right, honey?

WIFE. Of course, Bowzie.

NARR. So tell me, how did you meet?

BOWSER. Well, one day I was at the bottom of a castle throwing fireballs at tourists and I realized I was missing something. A hole that no fireball could fill: the hole of true love. In the past, every woman I abducted was rescued, but this time, I knew she would rescue me.

NARR. So....*how* did you meet?

WIFE. Online dating.

BOWSER. That's right, my little doll. I finally got the guts to send her an instant message.

WIFE. ChainedPrincess18.

BOWSER. And I was KoopaDupa21. It was like we were meant for each other.

NARR. So, no more fireballs?

WIFE. Well...

BOWSER. Uh....

WIFE. There are still fireballs, but he has a prescription for that.

BOWSER. I used to have to worry about little men throwing me into my own lake of magma. Now, it's Irritable Bowel Syndrome. Life is a balance.

NARR. So we decided to go back to Luigi to find out the scoop on the lost Mario brother—Wario.

LUIGI. Wario had the most troubled life out of us all. When we started our plumbing business, he didn't want anything to do with it. He went and got his own job as a pharmaceutical sales rep. Mistake number one. But what really did it was something we don't talk about.

NARR. And what is that?

LUIGI. Well, like I said, we don't talk about it...*because he was adopted.*

NARR. I decided to do a bit of my own investigation

WARIO. I JUST WANT TO TAKE OVER THE WORLD! (*evil laugh*)

NARR. Right...So why have you maintained a life of criminal intent as opposed to all other other ex-villains?

WARIO. I JUST WANT TO TAKE OVER THE WORLD! (*evil laugh*)

NARR. Exactly, but why?

WARIO. I JUST WANT TO TAKE OVER THE WORLD! (*evil laugh then cough*)

NARR. Disillusionment seemed to plague most characters I had interviewed, but two integral players, or, uh, playees still remained. The original adversaries: Donkey Kong and Super Mario.

DK. Yeah, we had some good times. I watched Mario develop from a small lad to a full blown fireballing machine, and I take full credit for giving him a start. I don't know why he gave up on the Princess, though. I guess he just got tired of chasing her from castle to castle.

NARR. Eventually, I grew tired of chasing Mario himself, trying to get an interview.
He seemed to still be a busy businessman, and his office in the Mushroom Kingdom repeatedly denied me interviews.

ASST. Hi, can I help you?

NARR. I am here to interview Mr. Mario, please.

ASST. Do you have an appointment? Let's see, no. No, you don't.

NARR. Yes, Two thirty.

ASST. I'm showing...no.

NARR. But I spoke with you on the phone....

ASST. Hold on. (*picks up phone*) Yeah, there's a guy out here with a camcorder, says he's interviewing you. No, he's too skinny. He can't be Michael Moore. Alright. Okay.Alright. Yes sir. Okay.

(The door creaks open. Narrator overlooks Mario because he is short and skinny.)

MARIO. It's a me, Mario! (*Narrator tries to figure out where voice is coming from, and sees Mario with his hand barely reaching the handle of the door. Mario switches to a regular voice.*) Okay, okay, you've got 5 minutes.

NARR. (*dumbfounded...pauses*) I'm uh, (*clears throat*), yeah, you're smaller in person.

MARIO. Don't flatter me, please. Now, what can I do for you?

NARR. Well, I have lots of questions. Perhaps we could break the ice with this

one. I am a huge fan of the original game you performed in, but I just wanted to know...what was up with Mario 2?

MARIO. I had bills to pay.

NARR. But....

MARIO. Listen, kid. Don't hate the player, hate the game, ok? (*phone starts ringing theme song*). Hold on. It's a me, Mario! Hello? (*hangs up*) Damn crank callers. (*rings again*) It's a me-okay, you shit. I've had enough. One more call and I stick a fireflower up your little goomba....

NARR. The interview was not going well. Afterward, though, he invited me to go out for a drink. It was there that he finally opened up.

MARIO. (takes a shot) No carbs. Beer is all carbs, man. Hey, gimme a shot for this guy. Okay, here's what happened. I got sick of the routine....The princess gets captured by an overweight villain, he tries to make it difficult to get to her, I jump over fire, climb ladders, get big, get small, I mean, after a while, you just start going through the motions and collecting your paycheck. Every pipe looks the same. So, I just decided to go into merchandising. The other actors don't like me anymore. They say I've just co-opted them to make money--and I have--but I do miss her.

NARR. Her?

MARIO. Yeah.

NARR. Where is she now?

MARIO. Last I heard, she left the kingdom and works at a Dillard's in Seattle. You know, in, uh, your world. It's just on the other side of the console, but it seems so far away.

(News flash comes on the TV in the bar.)

TV. We interrupt this broadcast for breaking news.

MARIO. I mean, how many times would I have to save her to earn her love? When is enough...enough? I just gave up. Somehow, it helped her-

NARR. Wait, look....

TV. In an unfortunate turn, the last of the Toadstool Dynasty, Princess Toadstool of the Mushroom Kingdom was abducted from her Orange County home by what appears to be a short tubby mustached man with eyes of fire. He was caught on tape saying only 7 words: "I want to take over the world!"

(Mario falls of his seat.)

NARR. Mario?

MARIO. I'm so weak. I can't believe this is happening again.

NARR. Mario. This is it. This is your time. It's time to become Super Mario.

MARIO. I told you man, no 'shrooms.

NARR. Did you see that picture? Did you see her eyes?

MARIO. I just don't have it in me.

NARR. Yes, you do. Mario, it's who you are.

MARIO. Shuttup, I've had enough of this Dr. Phil-Oprah-Maury Povich crap-

(Door bursts open and Luigi and Toadstool enter.)

TOAD. Hey, guys.

LUIGI. Here we go!

MARIO. What are you guys doing here?

LUIGI. We saw the news, and knew you'd be here. So we hopped the Green Pipe and came over.

MARIO. You mean you skipped level six?

TOAD. We'd do anything for you.

MARIO. (*pauses, smiles*). Bartender, give me a red mushroom, a fireflower, and two shots of tequila. I have a princess to save. (*they each eat a mushroom, and toadstool tries to eat himself*)

NARR. And so began their new journey. But this time, it wasn't a game. It was something more.